

Arslan Kaiser

Application to MSc. IUSD at Stuttgart

My journey as an architect in Lahore has been defined by a fundamental question: Why do we often treat the built environment as a triumph over nature, rather than an extension of it? Over the past several years of professional practice, I have witnessed how urban sprawl and profit-driven development—both in my home city and globally—often prioritize short-term wealth at the expense of ecological health and social equity. My ambition is to move beyond these systemic failures by mastering the tools and strategies necessary to rethink "modern" urbanism.

Since graduating from the National College of Arts in 2018, my work as an independent consultant has required me to bridge the gap between complex conceptual design and rigorous technical execution. Through remote collaborations on international projects, I have learned to navigate diverse building codes and environmental constraints, transforming them into data-driven, sustainable design solutions. However, as I have honed my expertise in Building Information Modeling (BIM) and computational workflows, I have realized that the next frontier of my professional growth lies in algorithmic structural optimization.

I am particularly drawn to the **Computational Design** module within the IUSD program. I aspire to move beyond manual calculation methods, which are inherently prone to human error at high levels of complexity, toward using parametric tools that automatically optimize structural parameters—such as calculating precise steel cross-sections based on real-time stress and load analysis. I believe that true architectural innovation is found in structures that push past traditional limits, and I am eager to use algorithmic design to harmonize structural performance with environmental responsiveness. This program's focus on the intersection of urban design and sustainability aligns perfectly with my moral obligation to the profession; I am looking to master the technical capacity to design buildings that are not only efficient but fundamentally resilient.

My professional philosophy is rooted in the belief that quintessential architecture is defined by the harmony between person, place, and space. I am eager to contribute my background in freelance consulting, my technical skills in parametric workflows, and my commitment to eco-social responsibility to the IUSD community. I am a firm believer in the power of international cooperation and the cross-pollination of cultures, and I am prepared to apply myself with the diligence and adaptability that have defined my career thus far.